RESEARCH NOTE / DIGITAL ACCESSIBILITY

ADA Title II Website Accessibility

A research brief on the 2024 U.S. Department of Justice web accessibility rule, updated 2026 deadlines, and potential applications for CrawlMetric.

RESEARCH STATUS	KEY STANDARD	PRIMARY AUDIENCE
Exploratory / no client audit claimed	**WCAG 2.1 Level AA**	**State & local government entities**

01 / What changed?

In April 2024, the Department of Justice adopted a rule under Title II of the Americans with Disabilities Act establishing specific accessibility requirements for web content and mobile apps that state and local governments provide or make available. The technical benchmark is WCAG 2.1 Level AA. In April 2026, DOJ extended the compliance dates by one year. [1][2]

02 / Current deadlines

Covered public entity	Compliance date
State or local government with population of 50,000 or more	April 26, 2027
State or local government with population under 50,000	April 26, 2028
Special district government	April 26, 2028

Deadlines depend on the rule's population definitions, not simply website traffic or staff count. Existing Title II accessibility obligations continue even before these dates. [1][2]

03 / Why accessibility matters

Accessibility affects whether people can complete essential tasks: reading public information, filling out forms, accessing services, navigating with a keyboard, using assistive technologies, or understanding video and audio content. For CrawlMetric, accessibility provides a measurable dimension of website quality alongside technical health and search visibility.

AUDIT FRAMEWORK / PROPOSED

What CrawlMetric could evaluate

The categories below are a proposed audit framework, not findings from a completed audit. Each item would require a defined test method and documented evidence.

Area	Example checks
Images & non-text content	Meaningful alternative text; decorative images handled correctly
Keyboard & navigation	Logical focus order; visible focus; no keyboard traps
Color & readability	Text contrast; resize and zoom behavior
Forms & controls	Accessible labels, instructions, errors, and button names
Structure & links	Headings, landmarks, page titles, descriptive links
Media & documents	Captions, transcripts where needed, accessible PDFs

04 / Proposed service workflow

FIND / Inventory pages, documents, and high-priority user journeys.

FIX / Document verified barriers and recommend practical corrections.

REFINE / Retest fixes and identify remaining usability problems.

REPEAT / Monitor new pages, content, and recurring issues over time.

05 / Limits and important distinctions

Automated scanning is not a compliance certification. Tools can surface possible problems, but human review and assistive-technology or keyboard testing are also needed. The rule contains limited exceptions for some content, subject to conditions. CrawlMetric should describe its service as accessibility testing and remediation support, not a legal guarantee. [1][3][4]

Title II is not a universal private-business deadline. Its rule specifically addresses state and local government entities. Private businesses may face separate accessibility obligations, including under ADA Title III; their legal position should be evaluated separately. [1]

EVIDENCE / RESEARCH SOURCES

06 / Evidence and verification

Record the affected URL, the barrier, its impact, and the test method for each finding. Separate automated flags from manually verified issues. Prioritize fixes that help people access information and complete essential tasks. After changes, repeat the relevant checks and document resolved and remaining barriers. Retesting supports evidence of improvement; it does not establish legal compliance or certification.

07 / Research sources

[1] U.S. Department of Justice, Title II web rule fact sheet
https://www.ada.gov/resources/2024-03-08-web-rule/

[2] Federal Register, April 20, 2026 interim final rule
https://www.govinfo.gov/app/details/FR-2026-04-20/2026-07663

[3] DOJ, First Steps Toward Compliance
https://www.ada.gov/resources/web-rule-first-steps/

[4] W3C Web Accessibility Initiative, Evaluating Web Accessibility
https://www.w3.org/WAI/test-evaluate/

Scope note: This document summarizes publicly available regulatory guidance for project planning. It is not legal advice, a completed website audit, or a claim of WCAG conformance.